Couple that with his upcoming election in 86 and you have the story.

We tried everything, wrote and rewrote the clause. The debate grew heated and then he took on the United States as being an interloper in European affairs, etc. The battle went on way past lunch hour. We finally settled for wording that bluntly said most of us felt there should be such a meeting and our ministers would meet in July to lay plans. Lunch came at about 2:30. Our dinner that night was heads of state only. Instead of business we got into story telling. [Canadian Prime Minister] Brian Mulroney started it and I got on with some and a good time was had by all.

May 5

Dawns the day the world has been hearing about for weeks. By 9 a.m. we were on our way to Konrad Adenauer grave site with the Kohls. Our wives put flowers on the grave. The press had only been given an hour's notice on this. We didn't want them claiming we were doing it to soften the criticism on Bitburg. From there we helicoptered to Bergen-Belsen concentration camp. This was an emotional experience. We went through the small museum with the enlarged photos of the horrors there. Then we walked past the mounds planted with heather each being a mass grave for 5000 or more of the people, largely Jews but also many Christians, a number of Catholic priests and gypsies who had been slaughtered there or who were just starved to death. Here I made the speech I hoped would refute the phony charges that had been made. I declared we must *not* forget and we must pledge "never again." Before the day was out there were reports that my talk had been effective. It was carried live on German TV and elsewhere in Europe.